

A Brilliant New \$15,900,000/Month Shopify Niche Store

Channel: Arie Scherson · Published: May 27, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=shL1DC7f2hg> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Arie Scherson breaks down Owner Active (Oner Active), a women's activewear DTC brand founded by influencer Krissy Cela, generating ~\$190M/year through polished Meta ads, strong brand identity, and a massive organic social following.

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Brand Overview: Owner/Oner Active 0:00

- The brand is called **Oner Active** (host is unsure of exact pronunciation throughout the video)
 - Founded by Krissy Cela, a large fitness/lifestyle influencer
 - Arie had never encountered the brand despite its massive scale
- Revenue: approximately **\$15.9 million per month**, or nearly **\$190–200 million per year**
- Sells women's activewear — a notoriously saturated niche in e-commerce
- Operates as a fully **direct-to-consumer (DTC)** model — no retail middlemen

Traffic & Geographic Breakdown 1:10

- Monthly website visitors: **~1.475 million** (approximately 1.4–1.5M)
- Largest traffic source: **United States** — but under 50% of total, meaning strong global reach
- Second largest market: **United Kingdom**
 - Arie notes the cultural and commercial similarity between the US and UK markets
- The sub-50% US share signals they are successfully pulling traffic from markets worldwide, not just one region

Visual Identity & Brand Aesthetic 1:56

- Their new releases feature a **muted, earthy color palette** that Arie describes as very on-trend right now
- He draws a direct parallel to **Rhode Skin (Road Cosmetics)** — another brand known for the same muted, clean aesthetic
 - Rhode was acquired by **Elf Cosmetics for \$1 billion** last year
 - Arie is a self-described **proud Elf investor** and believes Elf's ownership of Rhode alone is worth ~\$3 billion (his qualitative/intangible thesis)
 - Rhode gets ~**500,000 likes** on individual organic posts — extraordinary for a brand account
- Oner Active's organic Instagram engagement: ~**38,000 likes per post**
 - Arie frames this as impressive given it's organic content, not paid

Meta Ads Strategy 2:44

- Oner Active is running **over 840 active Meta ads** simultaneously
- Ads are notably **highly polished** — a deliberate choice that bucks the current trend
 - Arie's agency **Akemi** (a Meta agency partner) spends heavily on Meta each month
 - He notes the current best-performing format industry-wide is **unpolished, raw, authentic-looking ads**
 - Oner Active is going in the opposite direction — "full circle" back to extremely polished creative
- How to find any brand's full active ad library:
 - Go to the brand's **Facebook page**
 - Click their name → **Transparency** → **Go to Ad Library**
 - Shows all currently active ads for free
- Ads are sorted/viewed by **impressions (high to low)** to identify top performers

Short-Form Ad Formats & AI Content 4:40

- Top-performing ad example #1: a **6-second video**
 - Voiceover: *"I honor my body through strength"*
 - Extremely minimal — just brand-congruent visuals and a mission-driven line
- Top-performing ad example #2: a **14-second video**
 - Messaging: *"Designed for women, by women who lift"*
 - Arie highlights this as a powerful callout because many top sportswear brands are NOT founded by people within the community
- Arie's recommended strategy inspired by these ads:
 - Do **one high-quality, brand-congruent photo/video shoot**
 - Then produce **many 6–14 second variations** from that shoot to run as separate ads — "spam" them across Meta

- **AI content recommendation:**

- Arie encourages using AI tools to generate this type of short video content
- Tool mentioned: **Higgsfield** — used for AI video generation at "literal pennies" per video
- His team also built their own image tool called **Draft** (internal software)
- His take: AI-generated short brand videos are no different from paying a UGC creator; normalization is coming fast

Product Page Observations 8:02

- Best-sellers are analyzed because high sales volume = validated data on what works
- Product pages are described as **very clean and staged** — like a physical retail store display
- Notable: **no customer reviews** visible on product pages
 - Arie speculates this may signal a broader shift: as consumers trust the internet more, social proof via reviews may become less necessary
 - He checks Rhode's product pages for comparison — Rhode *does* have reviews (**7,000+ reviews**)
 - Arie calls this a "far stretch" as a thesis but flags it as worth watching

Customer Avatar & Audience Research 9:59

- Arie uses a free tool: **smartreply.io** — an AI comment analysis tool
 - He is a small shareholder in the company
 - Primary use case: scrapes Facebook comments for a brand and generates a summary report
 - Key feature he uses: **customer avatar identification**, including sub-avatars
- For Oner Active, identified avatars include:
 - **Confident active women** (primary/main avatar)
 - Sub-avatars:
 - Performance-driven lifters
 - Social media influencers (reflecting Krissy Cela's own identity)
- Strategic insight from sub-avatar analysis:
 - If you're competing in the same space, look for **underserved sub-avatars** within the broader market
 - Targeting a niche sub-avatar in your marketing can be a differentiation lever vs. competing head-on with a dominant player

Founder Story & Brand Parallels to Rhode 5:49

- Arie draws a strong parallel between Oner Active and **Rhode Beauty** as a DTC success template:
 - Rhode founder **Hailey Bieber** was already known as a skincare advocate before launching a skincare brand — authentic, community-embedded founder
 - **Krissy Cela** is deeply embedded in the fitness/lifting community — same authentic founder-market fit

The common thread: the most powerful DTC brands are built by founders who are *genuinely part of the niche* they're selling into — not outsiders manufacturing identity.

- Arie sees Oner Active as a potential **billion-dollar outcome** similar to Rhode's \$1B acquisition by Elf
- He plans to follow the brand's trajectory and check back in on its growth
- Also mentioned: **Evolve You** — linked from Krissy Cela's Linktree, suggesting she runs multiple brands/products